



—52 YEARS FOR SOUTHPORT KILLER—

‘What you did was not only cruel and pure evil, it was the act of a coward’

Mother of seven-year-old Elsie Dot captures nation's rage



A killer's eyes: Axel Rudakubana in a taxi before murdering Elsie Dot Stancombe, top left, Alice da Silva Aguiar and Bebe King

SOUTHPORT killer Axel Rudakubana is likely to die in jail for the ‘sadistic’ murders of three young girls.

The teenage knife attacker was yesterday jailed for at least 52 years for killing Bebe King, six, Elsie Dot Stancombe, seven, and Alice da Silva Aguiar, nine, as well as the attempted murder of

By **Richard Marsden**

eight other children and two adults at a Taylor Swift-themed dance class.

He was spared a whole-life term only because the horrific crime on July 29 last year happened nine days before his 18th birthday, when he was a juvenile.

But Mr Justice Goose, passing down 13 life sentences, said: ‘It is likely he will never be released.’ Family members in

Liverpool Crown Court took an audible breath as the sentence, thought to be the longest punishment handed to a killer of his age, was announced. Others held hands and hugged.

The court heard callous Rudakubana gloated about his sickening crimes in police custody, saying: ‘I’m glad those kids are dead, it makes me happy.’ He then tried to prolong the victims’ agony

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